WEDGIE.DEV

Put a wedgie together.

No soldering. 21 steps. Take your time on the wires (2 to 8); the rest just clicks.

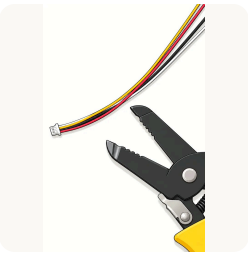
Latest version, with photos: **wedgie.dev/assemble**
Every step in 3D: **wedgie.dev/assemble/3d**

In your kit

- RP2040 Pico with headers
- Screen board: Waveshare Pico-LCD-1.3
- Chip board: Adafruit OPTIGA Trust M (4351)
- STEMMA QT / Qwiic cable
- Case: black base, white lid, joystick cap, 4 buttons

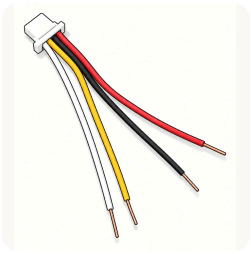
You need

- Wire stripper
- Electrical tape
- A stiff wire or pin
- Tweezers
- Pliers (step 10, if needed)
- USB data cable that fits your Pico
- A computer with Chrome



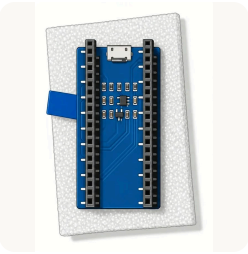
1 Cable and tools

In your kit: the STEMMA QT / Qwiic cable (4-pin JST-SH plug). You need: a wire stripper (it cuts near the hinge and strips near the tip), electrical tape, a stiff wire or pin, and tweezers.



2 Cut and strip the wires

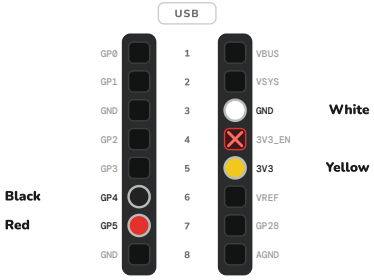
Keep one plug. Cut the wires about **2 in (5 cm)** from it, near the stripper's hinge. Strip with the notches near its tip. Strip off as much as a socket is deep, about **5 mm** (between 1/8 and 1/4 in), so the bare wire goes all the way down.

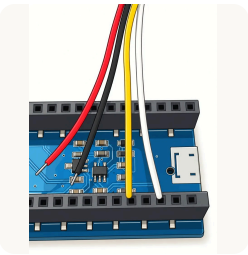


3 Lay out the screen board

Turn the screen board face down, sockets up, USB mark at the top. Each wire pushes into a socket, no solder. Count sockets from the USB end:

Never put anything in the 4th socket on the right row.

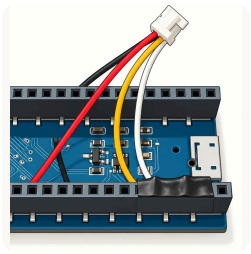




4 Push in white and yellow

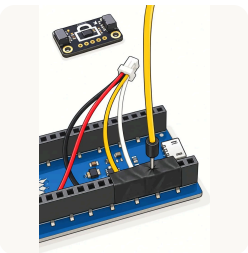
Twist the strands at each tip tight, so each acts like one solid wire. On the right row: **white into the 3rd**, **yellow into the 5th**.

This is the hard part. Slow down. Get every strand in, no stray wire sticking out anywhere.



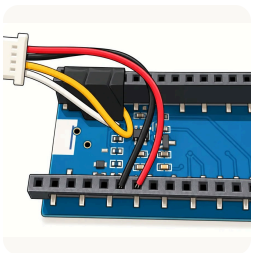
5 Tape over the wires

A small piece of electrical tape over those sockets, right on top of the wires, holds them in.



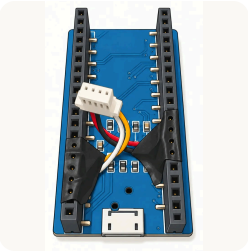
6 Poke the holes open

Push the stiff wire or pin through the tape into each covered socket. This opens the holes for the Pico's pins. The tape still holds the wires.



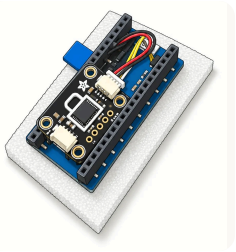
7 Black and red, same way

On the left row: **black into the 6th**, **red into the 7th**. Tape over them. Poke the holes open.



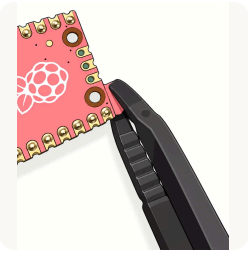
8 Header ready

All 4 wires in, taped, holes open. Ready for the Pico.



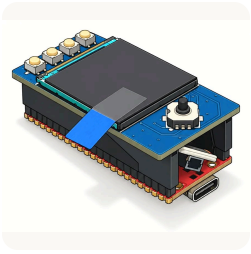
9 Plug in the chip

Plug the cable back into the Trust M, either socket: both work. It only fits one way. Tilt the Trust M on its side and wedge it between the two rows of sockets, over the wires. It should be a snug fit: the Pico goes on top of it next.



10 Snap off extra board

Some Picos have a little extra board left on the end, away from the USB port. Pinch it with pliers and snap it off. Otherwise it won't fit the case.



11 Stack the boards

Push the Pico into the sockets, **USB port at the same end as the screen board's USB mark**, the Pico's chips and BOOTSEL button facing out. Push straight, all the way in, until it's flush. The Trust M ends up wedged between the two boards.

No pin, wire or chip sticking out. If anything does, do it again: it won't fit the case.



12 Peel the screen protector

Pull the blue tab off the screen.



13 Case parts

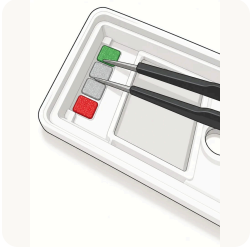
White lid, black base, joystick cap, 2 gray buttons, 1 green, 1 red.



14 Joystick cap

Line up the square hole with the joystick and press hard until it snaps. It takes more force than you'd think. It should stay on upside down and click up, down, left, right and in.

The small gap under the cap's rim is on purpose, so it can tilt.



15 Buttons into the lid

Lay the lid face down at the edge of the mat, so the buttons can hang out the front. Drop them in with tweezers: **green, gray, gray, red**. Green sits over the board's A button, red over Y.



16 Boards into the base

Screen up, **USB end first** into the base's hole, then lower the rest. Don't force it straight down. The screen board lies flat on the rails, the USB port centered in the hole.

The USB port must sit right in the middle of the hole. If it doesn't, something is wrong: take it out and do it again before you close the case.



17 Check the USB fit

Look at the USB end. The port must line up perfectly with the hole in the base.

Not lined up? Push the Pico all the way into the screen board's sockets, and make sure the screen board sits flush on the base's supports.



18 Close the case

Flip the base over and lower it, screen down, into the lid (still face down, buttons in). Line it up and press hard until it snaps. It's tight on purpose.



19 Check the feel

Press every button. Push the joystick every way and straight in. Each should click. Look for anything off: a tilted joystick, a stuck button.



20 Install the firmware

Unplug it. Hold the **BOOTSEL** button through the small hole in the base with a paperclip, and plug in a USB data cable (USB-C or micro USB, whichever your Pico has). Let go once it's in. Open **wedgie.dev/reset** in Chrome, click **Find it**, and follow the page. The screen stays dark until the firmware is on. Don't unplug while it runs.

Firmware done, but the screen is still dark or shows an error? A wire is in the wrong socket, a wire came out, or the Trust M touches a Pico pin. Open the case and check.



21 Install the software

Leave it plugged in. Open **wedgie.dev/connect** in Chrome and follow the page.

If something's off

It doesn't show up on USB
A charge-only cable, or BOOTSEL wasn't held while plugging in.

The screen stays black
The Pico isn't fully seated. Press it straight in until it's flush.

No chip found
A wire in the wrong socket, a wire that came out, or the chip board touching a Pico pin.

A wire keeps coming out
Twist the bare end tighter, push it all the way down, and tape it before the Pico goes in.

Stuck? Ask us.

Email **wedgie@buidlguidl.com** · Telegram **@austingriffith**